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SAMAGRASHIKSHA KERALA
SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT - III 2025-26

# ENGLISH

Std : VIII

Time : 1½ hrs.
Total Score: 40

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INSTRUCTIONS

- 15 minutes is given as cool off time.
- This time is to be used for reading the question paper.
- You are not supposed to write anything during the cool off time.
- Attempt the questions according to the instructions.

**Questions 1- 3: Read the excerpt from *A Tale of Two Gifts* and answer the questions that follow.**

**(3x1=3)**

Jim and Della were very proud of two things they owned. One was Jim's gold watch. It had once belonged to his father. And, long ago, it had belonged to his father's father. With a chain on his watch, Jim could look at it and learn the time anywhere he might be. Though the watch was so distinctive, it had never had a fine chain. He sometimes took it out and looked at it only when no one could see him do it.

The other thing was Della's hair. Della knew her hair was more beautiful than any queen's gold or gems. So now Della's beautiful hair fell around her, shining, like a falling stream of brown water. It reached below her knee. It almost made itself into a dress for her. And then she put it up on her head again, nervously and quickly. She stopped for a moment and stood still while a tear or two ran down her face.

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She put on her old brown coat and old brown hat. With the bright light still in her eyes, she moved quickly out the door and down to the street.

1. What was Jim proud of?
2. What was special about Della's hair?
   i) It fell around her, shining, like a falling stream of brown water.
   ii) It reached below her knee.
   iii) It almost made itself into a dress for her.
   iv) It was not as beautiful as any queen's gold or gems.

   Choose the right option:
   A) Only i is correct.
   B) Both ii and iv are correct.
   C) i, ii and iii are correct.
   D) None of the above.
3. Pick out a word/phrase from the passage which means 'to wear'.

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**Questions 4 - 6: Read the lines from *The Seven Ages of Man* and answer the questions that follow.**

**(3x1=3)**

All the world's a stage,
And all the men and women merely players;
They have their exits and their entrances;
And one man in his time plays many parts,
His acts being seven ages.

At first the infant,
Mewling and puking in the nurse's arms;
And then the whining school-boy, with his satchel
And shining morning face, creeping like snail
Unwillingly to school.

4. How does the poet describe the men and women in the poem?

5. What does the newborn do?

A) Mewling and puking B) Whining and laughing

C) Creeping and running D) Dragging and yelling

6. Identify an instance of simile from the stanzas above.

7. Read the lines from *Caged Bird* and using the hints given below, write a **short paragraph** summarising the ideas contained in the lines. **(1x4=4)**

A free bird leaps
on the back of the wind
and floats downstream
till the current ends
and dips his wing
in the orange sun rays
and dares to claim the sky.

But a bird that stalks
down his narrow cage
can seldom see through
his bars of rage,
his wings are clipped and
his feet are tied
so he opens his throat to sing.

*[Hints: Maya Angelou - opposing experiences of two birds - one lives freely - one in a cage - oppression - yearning for freedom - extended metaphor – imageries - alliteration]*

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**Questions 8-10: Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow.** **(3x1=3)**

Leo lived in a small village where there was frequent power failure. When the power died, the fans stopped spinning, and the nights became very hot. Most people just complained, but Leo spent his time in his backyard with a pile of old wires and shiny foil. "What are you building, Leo?" his friend Sam asked. "I'm building a kite that catches the sun," Leo said. Sam laughed. "Kites are for playing, not for power! "Leo didn't mind. He knew that the higher you go, the stronger the sunlight and the wind. He used lightweight plastic and covered it with thin solar strips he found at a recycling centre. He used a long copper wire as the kite's string to send the energy back down to earth.

One Saturday, the village transformer blew out. The whole town was dark. Leo took his kite to the top of the hill. He ran fast, and the wind caught the foil. The kite soared high above the trees, shining like a diamond. Back at his house, Leo plugged the end of the copper string into a large battery. Slowly, a small LED lamp began to glow. Then, he plugged in a small fan. His neighbours gathered around, feeling the cool air. They realized that Leo wasn't just playing. He had found a way to use the sky to help the village.

8. What did Leo use as the string of the kite?

9. While Leo was running fast, _____.

i) the wind caught the foil

ii) the kite got stuck on a tree

iii) the kite soared high above the trees

iv) Sam and Leo collided with each other

**Choose the correct option:**

A) i and ii B) iii and iv

C) ii and iii D) i and iii

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10. Why did Leo want to fly his kite higher than the trees?

**Questions 11 - 13: Answer either A or B.** **(3x4=12)**

**11. [A]** The visit to the rural village called *Village of the Watermills* gave the young man a new perspective about life. He jotted down his thoughts in his diary. Prepare the likely **diary entry**.

**OR**

**11. [B]** After reading the story *A Tale of Two Gifts*, you are fascinated by the deep love and passion of Jim and Della. Write a **letter** to them conveying how their gifts to each other reveal the true meaning of selfless love and care.

**12. [A]** The Nobel Prize laureate Malala Yousafzai's vision about girls' empowerment and her courage really inspires you. Draft an **email** to her congratulating her visionary zeal.

**OR**

**12. [B]** The Health Club of your school plans to conduct an eye check-up camp for the people of your locality. The camp will be led by Dr.Agarwal, the leading ophthalmologist of AIIMS, New Delhi. You are the secretary of the Health Club. Prepare a **notice**, including all the relevant details.

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13. [A] Write a **paragraph** describing the given picture in the light of your reading of the story *Thank you Ma'am*.



**OR**

13. **[B]** Jawaharlal Nehru's speech on the eve of India's independence highlights the need of people coming together to achieve greatness. Draft a **news report** of the event.

14. Prepare a short **profile** of Jawaharlal Nehru based on the hints given below. **(1x4=4)**

| | |
|---|---|
| Birth | :14 November, 1889, Allahabad |
| Famous as | : First Prime Minister of India |
| Major Works | : *Glimpses of World History* (1934), *An Autobiography* (1936), *The Discovery of* India (1946) |
| Awards | : Bharat Ratna (the highest civilian award) in 1955 |
| Death | : 27 May,1964, New Delhi |

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**Questions 15-17: The table contains the list of Shakespearean plays and their details. Study it and answer the questions that follow.** **(3x1=3)**

| Name of the Play | Protagonist | Category | Setting |
|---|---|---|---|
| Macbeth | Macbeth | Tragedy | Scotland |
| Othello | Othello | Tragedy | Venice |
| Much Ado about Nothing | Benedick | Comedy | Messina |
| The Tempest | Prospero | Tragicomedy | An enchanted island |
| The Merchant of Venice | Antonio | Comedy | Venice |

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15. Which of the following Shakespearean plays belong to the genre of comedy?

A) Othello

B) The Merchant of Venice

C) Much Ado about Nothing

D) Both B and C

16. Which of the given plays happen in the same locale?

17. Who is the protagonist of the play which is set on an enchanted island?

**18. Fill in the blanks using appropriate phrasal verbs given in brackets.** **(2x1=2)**

Before India's independence, we had to.....(a).....the brutal oppression unleashed by the British. Some of the evils still persist and we ought to .....(b).....fighting them.

(go on, come across, put up with)

**19. Edit the following passage. Errors are given in bold.** **(4x½=2)**

A moment **come** (a), which comes but rarely **on** (b) history, when we step out from the old to the new, when an age ends, and when the **sole** (c) of a nation, long **suppresses** (d) finds utterance.

**20. Report the following dialogue.** **(2x1=2)**

Young Man : The night is dark.

Old Man : Young man, we use candles and linseed oil.

a) The young man said .....

b) The old man told .....

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**21. Complete the conversation between Mrs. Luella Bates Washington Jones and Roger.** **(2x1=2)**

Roger : You are going to send me to jail, .....(a).....?

Mrs. Jones : No, I'm not going to send you anywhere.

Roger :.....(b).....?

Mrs Jones : I'm going to prepare food for us.

Roger : Thank you, ma'am.